

# Compound sentences

A COMPOUND SENTENCE IS A SENTENCE THAT HAS MORE THAN ONE MAIN CLAUSE.

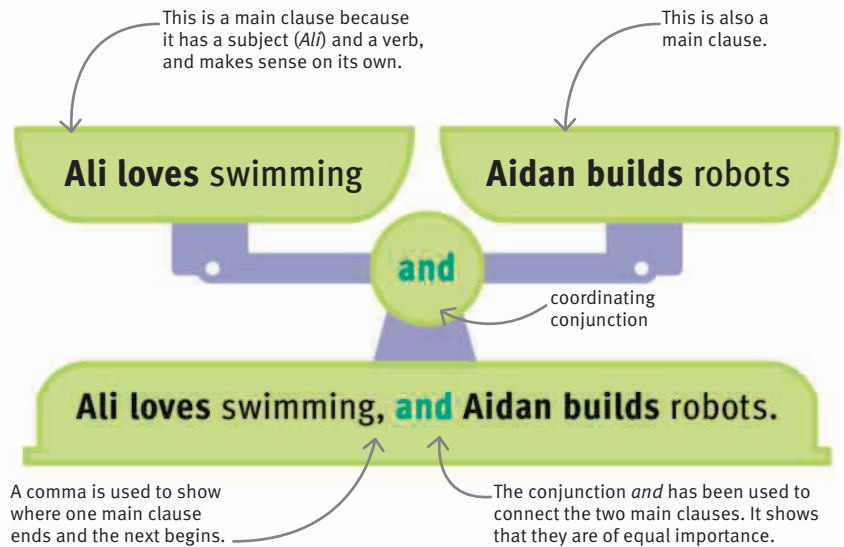
Compound sentences are made up of two or more main clauses, but no subordinate clauses. The main clauses are linked using conjunctions, and the resulting sentence conveys different ideas of equal importance.

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## Joining main clauses

Compound sentences are a useful way of connecting two or more ideas of equal importance. They help improve the flow of a piece of writing, as many successive simple sentences can be uncomfortable to read. To form most compound sentences, two main clauses—each containing a subject and a verb—are joined together using a coordinating conjunction like *and*, *but*, or *so*. A comma is used before the coordinating conjunction to separate the two clauses.



## Using conjunctions

There are seven main coordinating conjunctions, and these are used in different ways. The conjunction *and* is used to join two things that are alike, or to show that one thing follows the other. *But* is used to contrast one idea with another, while *so* indicates that the second thing occurs as a result of the first. *Yet* is used to mean "nevertheless," *or* and *nor* are used to link alternatives, and *for* is used in compound sentences to mean "because."

